belong to any distributed system, such as routing and service discovery. Cloud native applications are loosely coupled by definition, and that is also a feature of microservices.

Even if they have some similar aspects, it's essential to understand that cloud native applications and microservices are not the same. You can definitely use a microservices style for cloud native applications. Many developers do, but it's not a requirement. In this book, I will use an architectural style that we might call *service-based*. Perhaps it's not a catchy name or a fancy one, but it's enough for our purpose. We'll deal with services. They can be of any size, and they can encapsulate logic according to different principles. That doesn't matter. What we want is to design services to fit our development, organizational, and business needs.

1.7.2 Service-based architecture for cloud native applications

Throughout this book, we'll design and build cloud native applications according to a service-based architecture.

Our central unit of work will be a service that can interact with other services in different ways. Using the distinction proposed by Cornelia Davis in her book *Cloud Native Patterns* (Manning, 2019), we can identify two elements of the architecture: services and interactions.

- *Service*—A component that provides any kind of service to another component
- *Interaction*—The communication of services with each other to accomplish the system's requirements